CATEGORY WINNERS

INCLUSIVE DEVELOPMENT

LEAVING NO ONE BEHIND

With welfare policies focusing on the most marginalised sections, Bihar shows maximum improvement in inclusive development. Tamil Nadu emerges as the best performing one



CHANGEMAKER Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar

ANI



Ambitious schemes for the common weal do not bear the fruit of socio-economic inclusivity by themselves. For that most desired result to come about, one requires a synergy between good governance, an astute and honest administration coupled with the best-laid plans. Setting an example in inclusive development, Tamil Nadu and Mizoram are the best performing states this year.

Best Performing Big State: Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu stands out in its parallel focus on social welfare policies, in the areas of public education, social security and healthcare. It achieved the Millennium Development Goals far ahead of most states and is well on its way to achieve the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)—the state moved up to the second position in NITI Aayog's SDG index in 2020-21 from the third in 2019- 20. For successive chief ministers, an inclusive vision for social justice and uplifting disadvantaged groups has remained central concerns. While universalisation of the midday meal scheme is perhaps the state's most noteworthy accomplishment, Chief Minister M.K. Stalin has unveiled another programme to offer even free breakfast to children going to government primary schools. Other people-centric schemes started by him include free travel on public transport buses for all women and transgenders, healthcare delivery at the doorstep (Makkalai Thedi Maruthuvam), and cash-free immediate medical care to accident victims (Innuyir Kappom).

Best Performing Small State: Mizoram

In March this year, the then vice-president of India M. Venkaiah Naidu heaped generous praise on Mizoram for, among many positives, its excellent track record in continuing inclusive development efforts since the creation of the state five decades ago. Naidu appreciated the state government's flagship programme—Socio-Economic Development Policy (SEDP)—which aims at accelerating progress in key sectors and transforming Mizoram into a welfare state by achieving self-sufficiency in food items. Cultivation and processing of bamboo has been one of the most important components of the programme. Under SEDP, the government has started to provide direct monetary assistance to 60,000 households to supplement their ongoing economic activities or to start a fresh

WITH ITS FLAGSHIP SCHEME SEDP, THE MIZORAM GOVT AIMS TO ACHIEVE SELF-SUFFICIENCY IN FOOD ITEMS